

CarHunter

Employee Operating & Training Binder

The complete desk manual for a high-volume vehicle-acquisition operation. Find, value, prioritize, contact, and prepare deals — every day — with CarHunter as the command center.

Field	Value
Operation	Private-party + auction vehicle arbitrage (Utah)
System	CarHunter — Convex backend (deployment: silent-leopard-39) + React web app
Live data sources	KSL Cars (scraped) -> Laser Appraiser (book values) -> CarHunter feed
Your role	Execute the daily desk. Prepare deals. Contact sellers. Log everything.
Owner's role	Final purchase, bid, and risk decisions.
Golden rule	CarHunter is the source of truth. AI prepares the work. Humans decide.
Version / date	v1.0 — June 2026 (verify Capability Map before first shift)

Owner instruction to the employee: "Run the desk from this."

How to Use This Binder

Read SOP 1 (Operating Manual) and the Capability Map first. Then keep this binder open while you work — each SOP is a step-by-step you follow in order. Tables, scripts, checklists, and worksheets are ready to use. When something breaks, go to SOP 13 (Troubleshooting). When a deal is big, risky, or unclear, go to SOP 10 (Escalation).

The 11 Operating Principles (never break these)

- CarHunter is the source of truth. No side spreadsheets unless the owner approves one as a temporary backup.
- AI prepares the work; humans make the final call.
- You do NOT approve purchases or auction bids unless the owner has given you written authority.
- Every lead must have a next action. Nothing sits with no plan.
- Every seller conversation must be logged in CarHunter.
- Every valuation must show where it came from (source + date).
- Missing information is marked MISSING — never guessed.
- Fast response matters, but accuracy matters more.
- Mechanic-special deals only work when repair, labor, fees, and risk reserves are priced conservatively.
- Escalate high-value, high-risk, unclear, or time-sensitive decisions to the owner.
- If you make a mistake, log it and tell your manager immediately — do not hide it.

CarHunter Capability Map — What the System Does Today

This is the single most important page for accuracy. It tells you exactly what CarHunter does **automatically** versus what **you do by hand** today. Do not assume a feature exists if it is not listed as AUTO.

Capability	Status today	How it works / what you do
KSL private-party scrape	AUTO	Bright Data Web Unlocker pulls new KSL listings every 2 minutes into the feed.
Dedupe (one row per car)	AUTO	By VIN, else a year/make/model/mileage/zip key.
Deal score, HOT flag, est profit	AUTO	Scoring engine runs on every valued listing. HOT = est profit >= \$1,500.
Recon & fees estimate	AUTO	Base recon \$400 + drivetrain parts/labor rules; fees \$400 flat.
JD Clean Trade-in	AUTO (Laser bridge)	Captured per VIN from Laser (NADA Comm.Trade) while a Laser tab is open.
KBB value	AUTO (Laser bridge)	Captured per VIN from Laser (KBB wholesale).
JD Full Retail	MANUAL today	Read it in Laser (NADA 'Retail') and type it into the listing notes. Auto-capture is on the roadmap.
Base MMR (Manheim)	MANUAL today	Read it in Laser's MMR tab and type it into the listing notes. Auto-capture is on the roadmap.
MarketCheck live comps	OFF	No MARKETCHECK_KEY set; the system uses a depreciation-curve fallback (flagged 'curve', never HOT).
HOT deal SMS alert	AUTO	Sent via Mobile Text Alerts to the numbers in MTA_NUMBERS.
Pipeline board (Lead->Flipped)	AUTO	Move a lead through stages in CarHunter.
Auction run-list upload (in app)	MANUAL today	No upload screen yet. Use the Repair-Margin Worksheet (SOP 6 / Appendix) until it ships.
Employee task list / outreach kit screens	MANUAL today	Work leads from the feed + pipeline; use the Script Book (SOP 4) for outreach.
Owner decision packet	MANUAL today	Build it from the listing using the template in SOP 10.

Note on labels: Laser-sourced values may display in the app with the legacy tag 'carbly' as the valuation source. That is a naming leftover — the numbers come from Laser Appraiser. Always confirm the value and date.

Platform & API-Key Setup Guide (Beginning to End)

CarHunter runs on a handful of outside platforms. Most keys are already installed by the owner; you generally do NOT need to touch them. This guide exists so that if a key expires or the owner asks you to set one up, you know exactly where it goes and what can go wrong. Keys live in the Convex deployment's environment variables (Convex Dashboard -> your project -> Settings -> Environment Variables) or in an untracked .env.local file — NEVER in the code, chat, screenshots, or a spreadsheet.

Platforms used

Platform	What it does	Key / login needed	Already set?
Convex	Backend database + automation that runs CarHunter	CONVEX_DEPLOY_KEY (to deploy)	Yes
Bright Data	Web Unlocker proxy that lets us scrape KSL past bot protection	BRIGHTDATA_API_TOKEN + BRIGHTDATA_ZONE	Yes
Laser Appraiser	Book values (JD Clean, JD Retail, KBB, MMR) per VIN	Account login (no public API) + INGEST_SECRET	Yes
Mobile Text Alerts	Sends HOT-deal SMS	MTA_API_KEY + MTA_NUMBERS	Yes
MarketCheck	Optional live market comps (upgrades valuations)	MARKETCHECK_KEY	No (optional)
Vercel	Hosts the CarHunter web app	Vercel login + VITE_CONVEX_URL	Owner
GitHub	Stores the code	GitHub login	Owner

How to get each key (only if the owner asks)

1) Convex deploy key

- Go to dashboard.convex.dev -> sign in -> open the project (team zaki-5ed1c / project dddfd).
- Settings -> Deploy Keys -> Generate a Development deploy key. Copy it once (you cannot see it again).
- It is used only to deploy code (npx convex deploy). Day-to-day desk work does NOT need it.
- Hiccup: 'MissingAccessToken / 401 Unauthorized' when deploying = the key is missing or wrong. Re-generate.

2) Bright Data (Web Unlocker)

- brightdata.com -> sign in -> Proxies & Scraping -> the 'web_unlocker1' zone.
- API token: Account Settings -> API tokens. Zone name goes in BRIGHTDATA_ZONE (default web_unlocker1).
- Hiccup: KSL returns 403 / 'access denied' = token invalid, out of balance, or zone paused. Check the Bright Data balance and that the zone is active.
- Hiccup: scrape suddenly returns 0 cars = usually the token, not the code. Verify the token works (Bright Data has a test box in the zone page).

3) Laser Appraiser

- Laser Appraiser is a paid dealer subscription (laserappraiser.com). It has NO public API.
- We read values by running a small helper script inside YOUR logged-in Laser browser tab (the 'Laser bridge' — see SOP 8).
- You need: the Laser username + password (owner provides) and the CarHunter INGEST_SECRET (owner provides) pasted into the bridge script once.
- Hiccup: 'security session expired' = your Laser login timed out. Refresh the Laser page and the bridge resumes.
- Hiccup: values stop flowing = the Laser tab was closed. Keep one logged-in Laser tab open on an always-on computer.

4) Mobile Text Alerts (SMS)

- mobile-text-alerts.com -> sign in -> Account / API -> copy the API key into MTA_API_KEY.
- Put the phone numbers that should receive HOT alerts (comma-separated) into MTA_NUMBERS.
- Hiccup: no texts arriving = key missing, out of message credits, or numbers not opted in. Check the MTA dashboard balance + that numbers are subscribed.

5) MarketCheck (optional upgrade)

- marketcheck.com -> Developer / API -> request an API key -> put it in MARKETCHECK_KEY.
- When set, the system uses live market comps instead of the depreciation curve, and curve-only deals can become HOT.
- Hiccup: 401 from MarketCheck = bad key; 'subscribed package radius limit' = your plan caps the search radius (keep radius <= 100 miles).

6) Vercel + GitHub (owner-level, rare)

- Vercel hosts the web app. The only setting you might confirm is VITE_CONVEX_URL = <https://silent-leopard-39.convex.cloud>.
- GitHub stores the code on branch claude/magical-meitner-2i71q8. You normally never touch these.

Security rules for keys (do not break)

- Never paste a key into chat, email, a screenshot, or a spreadsheet.
- Keys live only in Convex env vars or an untracked .env.local on an approved machine.
- If a key is ever exposed, tell the owner immediately so it can be rotated.
- You do not need most keys to run the desk — only the Laser login + INGEST_SECRET for the bridge.

SOP 1: CarHunter Employee Operating Manual

Purpose

Give you the big picture of how CarHunter works and how your day fits into it so you can run the buying desk confidently from day one.

Who owns the process

You (the buying-desk employee) run it daily. Your manager supervises. The owner sets the rules and makes final buy/bid decisions.

When to use it

Read first, then keep as your reference for how the whole system fits together.

Required tools

- A computer with Chrome
- CarHunter web app login
- A logged-in Laser Appraiser tab (for book values)
- Phone/messaging for seller outreach
- This binder

Required inputs

None to read. To operate: the live CarHunter feed (it fills itself automatically).

Step-by-step process

- CarHunter scrapes KSL every 2 minutes and drops new cars into the feed automatically.
- Each car is valued (JD Clean Trade + KBB via the Laser bridge), scored, and flagged HOT if est profit $\geq$ \$1,500.
- You work the feed top-down: review, decide (contact / request VIN / watch / pass / escalate), contact sellers, log replies, schedule inspections.
- Strong or risky deals get packaged for the owner to approve.
- Approved deals move down the pipeline: Lead -> Contacted -> Negotiating -> Inspected -> Bought -> Flipped.

Decision rules

- Work HOT and mechanic-special cars first.
- Never guess a value or a fact — mark it MISSING and find it or escalate.
- Every lead leaves your hands with a next action set.

What to enter into CarHunter

Your decision on each lead, every seller message and reply, appointment times, and status changes. CarHunter is the record — nothing important lives only in your head or a notepad.

What not to do

- Do not approve a purchase or bid.
- Do not run side spreadsheets unless the owner approved one.
- Do not delete or overwrite another person's notes.

Escalation triggers

See SOP 10. In short: big profit, big spend, salvage/branded, major mechanical, missing VIN on a valuable car, conflicting values, seller pushing, auction time approaching, or you are unsure.

Common mistakes

- Chasing low-score cars while HOT ones expire
- Forgetting to log a call
- Trusting a value without checking its source/date

Troubleshooting

If anything in CarHunter, Laser, or outreach stops working, go to SOP 13 and follow the fallback steps.

Completion checklist

- I can explain the daily flow
- I know what is AUTO vs MANUAL (Capability Map)
- I know what I can decide vs must escalate

Example

New 2017 Honda Accord, \$6,500, JD Clean \$9,800, score 88, HOT. You confirm the value source/date, message the seller, ask condition + title + VIN, log the reply, and set a next action — all inside CarHunter.

SOP 2: Daily Buying Desk SOP

Purpose

A repeatable open-to-close routine so no opportunity is missed and every lead is moved forward each day.

Who owns the process

You run it. Manager spot-checks.

When to use it

Every shift, start to finish.

Required tools

- CarHunter feed
- Laser tab open (bridge running)
- Phone/messaging
- This binder

Required inputs

The live feed, your open leads, and any owner replies from yesterday.

Step-by-step process

- OPEN (first 15 min): confirm the Laser tab is open and the bridge shows recent 'posted' activity (SOP 8). Confirm the feed is updating (new cars with today's date). If not -> SOP 13.
- TRIAGE: sort the feed by deal score / HOT. Scan the Contact-Now (HOT) cars and any mechanic specials first.
- WORK EACH LEAD (SOP 3): review, decide, contact, log.
- FOLLOW-UPS (SOP 12): work yesterday's no-replies and scheduled callbacks.
- OWNER ITEMS: send any decision packets (SOP 10); action anything the owner approved.
- AUCTION (if a run-list came in): SOP 5 / SOP 6.
- CLOSE: every lead has a next action; every conversation is logged; flag anything still MISSING.

Decision rules

- HOT + fresh (listed today) = contact within the hour.
- Mechanic specials always get worked, even if score is moderate.
- If you run out of time, prioritize freshest HOT first.

What to enter into CarHunter

Status on every lead touched, all messages/replies, appointments, and a next action for each open lead.

What not to do

- Do not leave HOT cars sitting overnight without contact.
- Do not close the day with un-logged conversations.

Escalation triggers

Anything matching SOP 10 during triage goes to the owner immediately, not at end of day.

Common mistakes

- Starting with email/low-value cars instead of HOT
- Forgetting to verify the bridge is running at open

Troubleshooting

Feed not updating or no Laser values -> SOP 13.

Completion checklist

- Bridge confirmed running at open
- All HOT contacted or queued
- All conversations logged
- Every open lead has a next action
- Owner items sent

Example

8:30 open: bridge posted 2 min ago, feed shows 6 new cars overnight, 2 HOT. You contact both HOT sellers by 9:00, log replies by 9:30, then work the rest.

SOP 3: Private-Party Lead SOP

Purpose

The exact way to work a single private-party lead from open to owner-ready.

Who owns the process

You.

When to use it

Every private-party car you touch in the feed.

Required tools

- CarHunter listing detail
- Laser (book values)
- Script Book (SOP 4)

Required inputs

- Year, make, model, trim, VIN, mileage, location, asking price, title status, seller notes
- JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR
- Est recon, est fees, est profit, deal score, risk flags

Step-by-step process

- 1. OPEN the lead in CarHunter.
- 2. REVIEW the car: year/make/model/trim, VIN, mileage, location, asking price, title status, seller notes.
- 3. REVIEW the numbers: JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR, asking price, est recon, est fees, est profit, deal score, risk flags. Confirm each value shows a source + date. If JD Full Retail or MMR is blank, read it in Laser and enter it (MANUAL today).
- 4. SCAN for mechanic-special wording (see Decision rules).
- 5. DECIDE: Contact now / Request VIN / Watch / Pass / Escalate.
- 6. CONTACT the seller using the right script (SOP 4).
- 7. LOG the reply verbatim-ish in the lead (SOP 4 logging rules).
- 8. SCHEDULE inspection if it qualifies (SOP 11).
- 9. PREPARE owner review if it hits an escalation trigger (SOP 10).

Decision rules

- Mechanic-special wording to catch: needs engine, bad engine, blown motor, head gasket, needs transmission, no reverse, won't start, doesn't run, salvage, rebuilt, branded title, flood, frame damage.
- Contact now: HOT or strong score + plausible price + no disqualifying risk.
- Request VIN: value looks strong but VIN missing on a valuable car.
- Watch: marginal profit, or priced slightly high but could drop.
- Pass: price above book with no upside and no mechanic-special angle.
- Escalate: any SOP 10 trigger.

- Price-too-good (price < ~35% of book): treat as a red flag (error/scam/major damage) -> ask hard condition/title questions before getting excited.

What to enter into CarHunter

- Your decision (contact/request VIN/watch/pass/escalate)
- Any value you entered manually + its source (e.g., 'JD Retail \$13,300 — Laser, 6/21')
- Every message and reply
- Appointment time
- Next action

What not to do

- Do not contact before reviewing the numbers.
- Do not enter a value without its source.
- Do not mark a car Pass on a mechanic special without checking the repair-margin math (SOP 6).

Escalation triggers

Deal score 90+, profit over owner threshold, salvage/branded/flood/frame, major mechanical, missing VIN on a high-value car, conflicting values, seller pushing now, or you are unsure (SOP 10).

Common mistakes

- Skipping the mechanic-special scan
- Entering JD Retail/MMR without noting it came from Laser
- Passing a mechanic special without the worksheet

Troubleshooting

Values missing or look wrong -> SOP 9 (verify) and SOP 13 (system).

Completion checklist

- Car + numbers reviewed
- Mechanic-special scan done
- Decision recorded
- Seller contacted (or reason not)
- Reply logged
- Next action set

Example

2015 Subaru Outback, \$7,900, JD Clean \$11,200, KBB \$11,500, score 84, clean title. You enter JD Retail \$14,100 from Laser, message the seller, ask condition/title/VIN, log 'owned 3 yrs, clean title in hand, minor bumper scuff', set inspection for tomorrow 5pm.

SOP 4: Seller Outreach & Appointment-Setting Script Book

Purpose

Ready-to-send messages so outreach is fast, consistent, polite, and persistent — without pressure or false claims.

Who owns it / When

You. Use the moment a lead qualifies for contact (SOP 3). Personalize {year}/{make}/{model}; never send a blank template.

Required tools

CarHunter (to log every send + reply), phone/messaging app.

Style rules

- Short, natural, local-buyer tone. Polite but persistent.
- Ask for the appointment quickly.
- Ask condition + title clearly.
- Easy-close / cash-ready positioning.
- No pressure tactics, no false claims, no fake urgency.
- One-to-one only — never mass-blast.

The Scripts

1. Initial availability

Hi, is your {year} {make} {model} still available?

2. Availability + appointment request

Hi, is your {year} {make} {model} still available? I'm local and could come take a look today or tomorrow if that works.

3. Ownership + condition questions

How long have you owned it? And is there anything wrong with it that's not in the listing — mechanical, accidents, warning lights?

4. VIN request

Could you share the VIN? Just want to check the history and details before I come out so I don't waste your time.

5. Easy-close / cash-ready

If everything checks out, I can make it simple and be ready to move quickly. I do my own paperwork and don't mess around.

6. Seller has another buyer

Totally understand. If the other buyer doesn't end up taking it, I can be available quickly — feel free to reach back out anytime.

7. Polite follow-up

Hey, just following up on the {make} {model} — still available? Happy to come take a look whenever works for you.

8. Mechanic-special lead (general)

Hi, is the {year} {make} {model} still available? I buy cars that need work too, so the issues aren't a dealbreaker. Can you tell me what it's doing and whether you have the title?

9. Bad-engine lead

Hi, still have the {year} {make} {model}? I understand it's got engine trouble — that's okay, I work on these. Does it start at all, any knocking or overheating, and do you have a clean title in hand?

10. Bad-transmission lead

Hi, is the {year} {make} {model} still around? I know the transmission's acting up — no problem on my end. Does it move/shift at all, does reverse work, and is the title clean and in hand?

11. Appointment confirmation

Great — confirming for {day} at {time} at {location}. I'll text when I'm on my way. Thanks!

12. Running late

Hey, running about {minutes} minutes behind — still definitely coming. Appreciate your patience.

13. Voicemail

Hi, this is {name} about the {year} {make} {model} you have listed. I'm a local buyer and interested — please call or text me back at {phone}. Thanks!

14. Phone-call opening

Hi, calling about the {make} {model} you have for sale — is it still available? Great. Mind if I ask a couple quick questions before I come look?

15. Price conversation

I appreciate the listing price. Based on condition and what comparable ones are going for, I was thinking around {offer}. I can keep it simple and quick — does that work, or is there a number that does?

16. Owner handoff

Thanks — this looks like a strong one. Let me confirm a couple details on my end and I'll get right back to you today.
[Internally: escalate to owner per SOP 10 before committing.]

17. Polite pass

Thanks for the details and your time — it's not the right fit for me right now, but I appreciate it. Good luck with the sale!

Logging rules (do every time)

- Log every outbound message and every reply in the lead, with date/time.
- Capture facts the seller gives: ownership length, known issues, title status/in-hand, VIN, accident/flood, why selling.
- If they give a price, log it. If they go silent, set a follow-up (SOP 12).

What not to do

- No pressure tactics or fake deadlines.
- No claims you can't back up.
- No committing to a price/purchase — that's owner-approved (SOP 10).

Escalation triggers

Seller pushing for an immediate decision, a strong/HOT car, or any SOP 10 trigger -> escalate before agreeing to buy.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- Sending a template with {brackets} still in it.
- Not asking about the title.
- Not logging the reply.

- No reply? Use script 7 once, then follow SOP 12 cadence.

Completion checklist

- Right script chosen
- Personalized
- Sent + logged
- Condition + title asked
- Next action/follow-up set

Example

HOT 2016 Tacoma. You send Script 2, seller replies 'yes, owned 4 yrs, clean title, no issues.' You log it, send Script 11 to set 5pm today, and set inspection (SOP 11).

SOP 5: Auction Run-List SOP

Reality check

There is no in-app run-list upload screen yet (see Capability Map). Until it ships, you work run-lists with the **Repair-Margin Worksheet** (SOP 6 / Appendix) and Laser values. This SOP describes the full intended flow AND the manual method to use today.

Purpose

Turn an auction run-list into a ranked, owner-ready bid sheet — every vehicle valued, scored, and risk-flagged.

Who owns it / When

You prepare it; the owner approves max bids. Use whenever a CSV/XLSX/PDF run-list arrives before a sale.

Required tools

- The run-list file (CSV/XLSX/PDF)
- Laser Appraiser (JD Clean, JD Retail, KBB, MMR by VIN)
- Repair-Margin Worksheet (Appendix)
- CarHunter (to log decisions/notes)

Step-by-step process

1. **UPLOAD/INTAKE:** when the in-app uploader exists, drag in CSV/XLSX/PDF and map columns. Today: open the file and work it row by row into the worksheet.
2. **MAP COLUMNS:** identify VIN, year/make/model, mileage, lane, run number, announcements, title status, seller, condition. Save the mapping per auction house for reuse.
3. **REVIEW LOW-CONFIDENCE ROWS:** any row with a bad/short VIN, blank mileage, or garbled make/model — fix or mark MISSING.
4. **CONFIRM** the key fields per vehicle: auction date, lane, run #, VIN, mileage, announcements, title status, seller, condition.
5. **ENRICH:** get JD Clean, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR for each VIN (Laser). For mechanic-special announcements, switch to SOP 6.
6. **SCORE/SORT:** rank by estimated profit and deal score; surface risk and missing-data rows; note lane time order.
7. **PREPARE** the owner bid-review packet (SOP 10) with a recommended max/target/walk-away per vehicle.

Decision rules

- No VIN = no firm value. Mark MISSING; do not invent a value.
- Any mechanic-special / damage / title announcement -> SOP 6 worksheet (mandatory).
- Sort priority: profit, then deal score, then risk, then lane time, then missing-data.

What to enter into CarHunter

Log the run-list reviewed, per-vehicle values + source/date, risk flags, and your recommended numbers. The owner's approved max bid is recorded before the sale.

What not to do

- Never bid without an owner-approved max bid.

- Never guess values for no-VIN rows.
- Never skip announcements — they change everything.

Escalation triggers

Every bid recommendation goes to the owner (SOP 10). Escalate early if lane time is close.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- Ignoring announcements
- Mismatched columns (VIN in wrong field)
- PDF won't parse -> fall back to manual entry; log which rows you did by hand.

Completion checklist

- All rows mapped/confirmed
- Low-confidence rows fixed or marked MISSING
- Every biddable vehicle valued (source+date)
- Mechanic specials run through SOP 6
- Bid packet sent to owner

Example

60-car run-list. You confirm fields, value all VINs in Laser, flag 4 'engine knock' cars to SOP 6, rank the rest by profit, and send the owner a 9-car bid packet with max bids.

SOP 6: High-Risk / High-Return Mechanic-Special Auction SOP

Purpose

A strict, conservative workflow for auction (or private-party) vehicles with major mechanical or title risk, so a 'cheap' car never turns into a loss. Every triggered vehicle gets a Repair-Margin Worksheet before any bid is recommended.

Who owns it / When

You complete the worksheet; the owner approves the max bid. Use it whenever any trigger phrase appears.

Trigger phrases (any one = mandatory worksheet)

- needs engine, bad engine, blown motor, knocking, head gasket, overheating
- needs transmission, bad transmission, no reverse, slipping transmission, does not move
- won't start, does not run
- salvage, rebuilt, branded title, frame damage, flood, parts only

Required tools/inputs

- Laser values (JD Clean, JD Retail, KBB, MMR)
- Local engine/trans quotes (SOP 7)
- This worksheet (Appendix has a blank copy)

Default reserves (use owner Settings if different)

Item	Default	Notes
Engine labor reserve	\$1,000	Per owner. Use Settings value if it differs.
Transmission labor reserve	\$1,000	Per owner. Use Settings value if it differs.
Standard recon	\$400	Base detail/transport/light recon.
Diagnostic reserve	\$250	Scan/inspection to confirm the real problem.
Unknown-risk reserve	\$750	Buffer for the second hidden problem. Raise for older/luxury/EV.
Target profit (min)	\$1,500	Mechanic specials: recommend \$2,000-\$3,000 due to risk.
Auction fees	actual / \$400	Use the house's fee schedule.
Transport	actual / \$150-\$500	By distance.
Title/admin fees	\$150	Title, temp tag, paperwork.

Repair-Margin Worksheet — fields to fill for EACH triggered vehicle

- Vehicle (year/make/model/trim), VIN, mileage, auction lane/run, announcement, title status, exit strategy (retail or wholesale)
- JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR, Expected exit value
- Auction fees, transport, title/admin fees, standard recon
- Engine part quote low/mid/high, engine labor reserve (\$1,000 default)
- Transmission part quote low/mid/high, transmission labor reserve (\$1,000 default)
- Diagnostic reserve, unknown-risk reserve, target profit
- Walk-away (engine), Walk-away (transmission), Walk-away (worst case both), Recommended action

Formulas (use the MID part quote for the recommendation; check HIGH for safety)

Engine-scenario walk-away = expected exit value – auction fees – transport – title/admin – standard recon – engine part cost – engine labor reserve – diagnostic reserve – unknown-risk reserve – target profit

Transmission-scenario walk-away = expected exit value – auction fees – transport – title/admin – standard recon – transmission part cost – transmission labor reserve – diagnostic reserve – unknown-risk reserve – target profit

Worst-case walk-away = expected exit value – auction fees – transport – title/admin – standard recon – engine part cost – engine labor reserve – transmission part cost – transmission labor reserve – diagnostic reserve – unknown-risk reserve – target profit

Decision rules

- Recommend the MAX BID at or below the relevant walk-away for the announced problem (use worst-case if BOTH systems are suspect or title is branded).
- Branded/salvage/flood/frame: use a wholesale exit value and a larger unknown-risk reserve; never assume retail exit.
- If the worst-case walk-away is at/below \$0, recommend PASS — there's no room.
- Always price with the MID quote; if HIGH quote turns it negative, flag it for the owner.

What to enter into CarHunter

Attach/record the completed worksheet to the vehicle: all inputs, the three walk-aways, your recommended max bid, and a one-line recommendation (bid/watch/pass). Note every quote's source (SOP 7).

What not to do

- Never use only the LOW part quote.
- Never skip the diagnostic + unknown-risk reserves.
- Never recommend a bid above the worst-case walk-away on a both-systems or branded car.
- Never bid without owner approval.

Escalation triggers

Every mechanic-special bid recommendation goes to the owner (SOP 10). Escalate immediately if lane time is near.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- Optimistic exit value (using retail on a branded car)
- Forgetting transport/fees
- No local quote yet -> get one (SOP 7) before recommending; if impossible, mark MISSING and recommend WATCH/PASS, not a guess.

Completion checklist

- Trigger identified
- All values + quotes entered with sources
- 3 walk-aways computed
- Recommended max bid set
- Sent to owner

Worked example

2016 Ford Escape, 'engine knock', clean title. Exit (JD Retail) \$11,000. Fees \$400, transport \$200, title/admin \$150, recon \$400. Engine part mid \$2,300, engine labor \$1,000, diagnostic \$250, unknown-risk \$750, target profit \$2,000. Engine walk-away = $11,000 - 400 - 200 - 150 - 400 - 2,300 - 1,000 - 250 - 750 - 2,000 = \$3,550$ max bid. Recommend: BID up to \$3,550.

SOP 7: Engine & Transmission Local Pricing SOP — Utah

Purpose

Get real, local repair/part costs so the Repair-Margin Worksheet (SOP 6) is accurate, not guessed.

Who owns it / When

You. Use before recommending any mechanic-special bid/offer where engine or transmission work is in play.

Where to get quotes (Utah)

- Local salvage yards / 'pull-a-part' yards (used engines & transmissions, often with mileage + warranty)
- Auto recyclers (LKQ-type) and used-parts locators
- Transmission specialty shops (reman/rebuilt trans + install labor)
- General mechanic shops (install labor, diagnosis)
- Dealer parts departments (only when used isn't available or for exact fitment)
- Approved online parts sources that ship to Utah
- Owner-approved vendors list (ask your manager for the current list)

Labor defaults

Unless owner Settings say otherwise, price engine replacement labor at about \$1,000 and transmission replacement labor at about \$1,000. These are reserves — if a shop quotes higher install labor, use the shop's number and note it.

Required: log EVERY quote with these fields

Field	Example
Vendor name	Wasatch Auto Recyclers
Contact method	Phone / website / in-person
Contact person	Mike
Phone or URL	801-555-0143
Date/time	2026-06-21 10:15
VIN or exact Y/M/M/engine	2016 Ford Escape 2.0L EcoBoost
Engine/transmission code	T/A 2.0L; 6F35 trans
Mileage on used part	78,000
Warranty	90-day parts warranty
Part-only price	\$2,300
Core charge	\$200 (refundable)
Shipping/delivery	\$0 local pickup
Availability date	In stock
Labor quote (if applicable)	\$1,100 install
Notes	Engine tested, has compression report
Confidence level	High / Medium / Low

Decision rules

- Get at least 2 quotes when time allows; use the MID for the worksheet, keep the HIGH for safety.
- Prefer tested used parts with a warranty over the cheapest no-warranty option.

- Add the core charge and shipping into the part cost.
- Low confidence on a quote -> widen the unknown-risk reserve in SOP 6.

What to enter into CarHunter

Attach the quote log to the vehicle and feed the chosen part cost + labor into the SOP 6 worksheet. Every number must show its vendor + date.

What not to do

- Never use a number with no vendor/source.
- Never quote labor below the \$1,000 default unless owner Settings say so.
- Never forget core + shipping.

Escalation triggers

Part unavailable, only dealer-new available (very expensive), or quotes vary wildly -> escalate with the numbers to the owner.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- Quoting the wrong engine size/fitment
- Forgetting core charge
- Only one low-confidence quote -> get a second or mark Low confidence + raise reserve.

Completion checklist

- 2 quotes when possible
- All log fields filled
- Core + shipping included
- Chosen cost fed into SOP 6
- Confidence noted

Example

Escape 2.0L: Yard A used engine \$2,300 (90-day warranty, 78k mi, +\$200 core) and Yard B \$2,600 (6-mo warranty). Use \$2,300 mid in the worksheet, note Yard B as the HIGH safety check.

SOP 8: Laser Appraiser A-to-Z SOP

Important

Laser Appraiser has **no public API**. CarHunter reads its values by running a small helper script (the 'Laser bridge') inside YOUR logged-in Laser browser tab. Exact on-screen button/tab names can change — where this SOP says VERIFY LIVE, confirm the current screen in the authorized account and capture a screenshot/recording for the binder. Do not guess UI you haven't confirmed.

Purpose

Keep accurate JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB, and MMR values flowing into CarHunter via Laser.

Who owns it / When

You. Set up once; then keep a logged-in Laser tab open every working day.

A. Login

- Open laserappraiser.com and log in with the account the owner provided (username/password).
- MFA/password rules: VERIFY LIVE whether the account uses 2-factor. If it does, the owner must provide the method. Never store the password anywhere but the approved location.
- If login fails: confirm caps lock, try a password reset only with owner approval, and check the subscription is active. Repeated failure -> escalate to owner (account may be locked or expired).

B. Turn on the bridge (one-time)

- Install the Tampermonkey browser extension, create a new script, paste the CarHunter Laser-bridge script (owner/manager provides it), set the SECRET line to the INGEST_SECRET, save.
- OR (temporary) paste the console version into the Laser tab's DevTools Console.
- Keep one logged-in Laser tab open on an always-on computer. The bridge appraises queued VINs automatically every ~60 seconds.

C. Confirm it's working

- On the Laser tab press F12 -> Console, filter for 'bridge'. You should see 'auto-bridge running' then 'posted -> {appraised:N...}'.
- In CarHunter, new cars should show JD Clean + KBB with a recent valuation date.

D. Vehicle lookup / values

- The bridge looks up each queued VIN automatically. To check a single car by hand: in Laser, search the VIN and open the vehicle (VERIFY LIVE the exact search box/screen).
- Confirm year, make, model, trim, mileage, region, condition, options match the listing before trusting the values.
- Capture JD Clean Trade (NADA 'Trade' clean), JD Full Retail (NADA 'Retail'), KBB (KBB value), Base MMR (Manheim MMR tab). VERIFY LIVE the exact tab labels and screenshot them for this binder.
- If the VIN is missing: look up by exact year/make/model/trim/mileage; mark the value 'by Y/M/M, VIN unconfirmed' and treat as lower confidence.

E. Get values into CarHunter

- JD Clean + KBB: automatic via the bridge — no typing.
- JD Full Retail + MMR (MANUAL today): read them in Laser and enter them in the listing's valuation notes with source+date, e.g. 'JD Retail \$13,300 / MMR \$11,900 — Laser, 6/21'.

- CSV import: if/when a CSV import exists, follow SOP 9; today, manual entry is the method for Retail/MMR.

F. Missing / stale / conflicting values

- Missing: mark MISSING; do not guess. Re-run the lookup or enter manually from Laser.
- Stale: if a value's date is old (>2 weeks) re-pull it.
- Conflicting: if JD and KBB or MMR disagree a lot, note it and treat as a risk flag; escalate if it's a high-value car (SOP 10).

Troubleshooting

- 'security session expired' in the console -> refresh the Laser page; the bridge resumes.
- No 'posted' lines -> the Laser tab was closed or you're on the wrong page (must be the Laser app, not the marketing/login page).
- Backend 'unauthorized' -> the SECRET in the script is wrong; fix it.
- Values look wrong for the car -> confirm trim/mileage/options in Laser (wrong trim = wrong value).

Escalation rules

Login won't work after a reset, subscription expired, MFA blocking automation, or values are repeatedly missing/wrong on valuable cars -> escalate to owner.

Completion checklist

- Logged in
- Bridge running (saw 'posted')
- Values flowing into CarHunter
- Manual Retail/MMR entered where needed
- Screenshots of live Laser screens added to binder

Example

Morning: open Laser, bridge shows 'posted -> {appraised:8}'. A 2018 Camry shows JD Clean \$14,150 + KBB \$13,500 automatically; you add JD Retail \$17,200 + MMR \$13,900 from Laser into the notes with today's date.

SOP 9: Valuation Import & Verification SOP

Purpose

Make sure every car shows correct values with a clear source and date, and that nothing is guessed.

Who owns the process

You. Manager audits (SOP 14).

When to use it

On every lead before you contact, and before any owner packet.

Required tools

- CarHunter listing
- Laser (source of book values)
- SOP 8 for capture, SOP 7 for repair quotes

Required inputs

- JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR
- Asking price / lane estimate
- Est recon, est fees, est profit, deal score, risk flags

Step-by-step process

- 1. Confirm JD Clean + KBB populated by the bridge (and recent).
- 2. Enter JD Full Retail + MMR from Laser if blank (MANUAL today) with source+date.
- 3. Confirm asking price matches the live listing.
- 4. Sanity-check recon/fees/profit/score; for mechanic specials, replace the auto recon with the SOP 6 worksheet.
- 5. Verify each value's SOURCE + DATE is recorded. Re-pull anything stale.
- 6. Mark anything you can't confirm as MISSING.

Decision rules

- If values conflict materially (e.g., JD vs KBB far apart), flag risk and, on a valuable car, escalate.
- If price < ~35% of book -> price-outlier flag (error/scam/major damage); verify before trusting.
- Curve-sourced value (no real book) is low confidence and never HOT — get a real Laser value.

What to enter into CarHunter

All four book values with source+date, confirmed asking price, and (for specials) the worksheet recon. Note label quirk: Laser values may show source 'carbly' — that's a legacy tag; the data is from Laser.

What not to do

- Never enter a value without its source/date.
- Never trust a 'curve' value as final on a real decision.
- Never overwrite a value without noting why.

Escalation triggers

Conflicting values on a high-value car, repeated missing values, or price-outlier on a valuable car -> SOP 10.

Common mistakes

- Leaving JD Retail/MMR blank
- Trusting stale values
- Not noticing the value came from the curve fallback

Troubleshooting

Values missing/stale/wrong -> SOP 8 (Laser) and SOP 13 (system).

Completion checklist

- 4 books present or MISSING marked
- Each value has source+date
- Asking price confirmed
- Recon correct (worksheet for specials)
- Risk flags reviewed

Example

2019 RAV4: bridge gives JD Clean \$19,000 + KBB \$19,300; you add JD Retail \$24,500 + MMR \$19,800 from Laser (6/21). Asking \$17,500. Profit and score check out; no conflict; ready to work.

SOP 10: Owner Escalation & Decision Packet SOP

Purpose

Get the owner exactly what they need to make a fast, confident buy/bid/pass decision — and nothing they don't.

Who owns the process

You build the packet; the owner decides.

When to use it

Whenever a deal hits any escalation trigger below.

Required tools

- CarHunter listing
- Laser values
- SOP 6 worksheet (if mechanical/auction)
- Owner's preferred contact channel

Required inputs

The full valuation set, seller conversation summary, inspection status, and your recommendation.

Escalation triggers (escalate if ANY are true)

- Deal score is 90+
- Estimated profit exceeds the owner's threshold
- Purchase amount exceeds your authority
- Title is salvage, rebuilt, branded, flood, frame, or unclear
- A major mechanical issue exists
- VIN is missing on a high-value deal
- Valuations conflict materially
- Seller is pushing for immediate action
- Auction lane time is approaching
- You are unsure

Owner Decision Packet — include ALL of this

- Vehicle summary (year/make/model/trim, mileage, location)
- Source/link
- Asking price or lane estimate
- JD Clean Trade, JD Full Retail, KBB Lending, Base MMR (each with source+date)
- Estimated recon
- Estimated fees
- Repair scenarios if relevant (SOP 6 walk-aways)
- Estimated profit

- Deal score
- Risk flags
- Seller conversation summary
- Inspection status
- Your recommendation
- The EXACT decision requested from the owner

Step-by-step process

- 1. Confirm values are verified (SOP 9).
- 2. Summarize the seller conversation (facts, price, urgency).
- 3. State inspection status.
- 4. Fill the packet template (Appendix).
- 5. Give ONE clear recommendation + the exact ask.
- 6. Send via the owner's channel and log that you escalated + when.
- 7. When the owner replies, log the decision and act on it.

Decision rules

- Ask for ONE specific decision (e.g., 'Approve buy up to \$7,800?' / 'Approve max bid \$3,550?').
- Never bury the ask. Never send a packet missing a value — mark MISSING if truly unknown.

What to enter into CarHunter

The packet contents, the time you escalated, the owner's decision, and the resulting next action.

What not to do

- Do not commit to the seller/auction before the owner approves.
- Do not send vague 'what do you think?' messages — give a recommendation.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- Missing the exact ask
- No risk flags listed
- Owner unreachable + lane time close -> follow the owner's standing rule; if none, do NOT bid.

Completion checklist

- All packet fields present
- Values sourced+dated
- One clear recommendation + exact ask
- Sent + logged
- Decision recorded

Example

'2023 Silverado 2500 LS, 105k mi, North SLC. Ask \$15,000. JD Clean \$34,000 / JD Retail ~\$38,000 / KBB \$28,000 / MMR (pending). Recon \$400, fees \$400, est profit ~\$19,000, score 100. Risk: confirm not branded, high miles. Seller

responsive. Inspection not yet set. Recommend: approve buy up to \$16,000 pending clean title + test drive. Decision requested: approve max purchase \$16,000?

SOP 11: Inspection Scheduling SOP

Purpose

Get qualified cars physically inspected/test-driven quickly and safely so a buy decision is based on facts.

Who owns the process

You schedule; the owner or an approved buyer inspects/buys.

When to use it

Once a lead is promising and the seller is responsive.

Required tools

- Calendar
- Seller contact
- CarHunter (log appointment)
- Inspection checklist (Appendix)

Required inputs

- Confirmed availability
- Location
- Title status (clean & in hand?)
- Known issues

Step-by-step process

- 1. Confirm the car is still available and the title is in hand.
- 2. Offer specific time windows (today/tomorrow).
- 3. Confirm exact address + meeting spot (public, daytime when possible).
- 4. Send Script 11 (confirmation).
- 5. Log the appointment + who is attending in CarHunter.
- 6. Send Script 11 reminder day-of; Script 12 if running late.
- 7. After inspection, log condition findings + photos and update status.

Decision rules

- No title in hand = flag and confirm plan before spending time.
- Meet in safe, public locations in daylight when possible.
- Bring the SOP 6 worksheet for mechanic specials.

What to enter into CarHunter

- Appointment date/time/location
- Attendee
- Post-inspection condition notes + photos
- Updated status + next action

What not to do

- Don't schedule without confirming availability + title.
- Don't skip logging the appointment.
- Don't authorize a purchase at inspection unless the owner pre-approved it.

Escalation triggers

Seller won't show title, story changes at inspection, or value/condition differs materially from the listing -> escalate before buying.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- No-shows -> SOP 12 follow-up
- Unsafe meeting request -> reschedule to public spot
- Forgot to log photos

Completion checklist

- Availability+title confirmed
- Time+place set + confirmed
- Logged in CarHunter
- Reminder sent
- Findings logged after

Example

2016 Tacoma: seller confirms clean title in hand; you set Sat 10am at a bank parking lot, log it, send confirmation, and attach the inspection checklist to the lead.

SOP 12: Follow-Up & Missed-Deal SOP

Purpose

Make sure no lead dies from silence and learn from deals we lose.

Who owns the process

You.

When to use it

Any lead with no reply, a soft 'maybe', a competing buyer, or a deal that fell through.

Required tools

- CarHunter (statuses + follow-up reminders)
- Script Book (7, 6, 17)

Required inputs

Open leads, last-contact dates, reason for any loss.

Step-by-step process

1. NO REPLY: follow up once with Script 7 after ~24h, again after ~48-72h, then mark Watch or Dead with a reason.
2. ANOTHER BUYER: Script 6, set a follow-up for 3-5 days out in case it falls through.
3. PRICE GAP: log their number, set Watch, revisit if the listing ages/price drops.
4. MISSED/EXPIRED: if a HOT car sold before we acted, log it as Missed with the reason (slow contact? owner delay? value wrong?).
5. Review Missed reasons weekly with your manager to fix the cause.

Decision rules

- Max ~3 polite touches, then Watch/Dead — no pestering.
- Always set the NEXT follow-up date; never leave 'waiting' open-ended.
- A price-gap car that drops to our number becomes active again.

What to enter into CarHunter

- Each follow-up + reply
- Status (Watch/Dead/Missed) with a reason
- Next follow-up date

What not to do

- Don't spam.
- Don't let leads sit with no next action.
- Don't mark Dead without a reason.

Escalation triggers

A HOT car we missed due to a process gap (slow approval, wrong value) -> flag to owner/manager so we fix it.

Common mistakes / Troubleshooting

- No next-action date set
- Marking Dead with no reason (kills our learning)
- Over-following-up

Completion checklist

- Follow-ups logged
- Status + reason set
- Next date set (if still open)
- Missed deals logged with cause

Example

HOT Civic, no reply: Script 7 at 24h, again at 72h, still nothing -> Watch with 'no response x2'. Three days later price drops \$1,000; it re-surfaces and you re-engage.

SOP 13: System Troubleshooting SOP

Purpose

Keep the desk running when a tool breaks, with safe manual fallbacks — and know when to stop and escalate.

Who owns the process

You first; manager/owner for anything you can't resolve in ~15 minutes.

When to use it

Any time CarHunter, imports, Laser, the bridge, or outreach misbehave.

Required tools

- This SOP
- Manager/owner contact
- A temporary note pad ONLY as approved backup

Step-by-step process (by symptom)

- CarHunter won't load: refresh; try another browser; check internet. Still down >15 min -> notify owner; work follow-ups/outreach you already have.
- Lead import / feed not updating: check the Laser bridge is running (SOP 8) and that the KSL scrape is alive; if no new cars in 30+ min, notify owner (likely the Bright Data token or scrape) — SOP 13 'scrape' below.
- Scrape returns nothing: usually the Bright Data token/balance, not the code. Notify owner to check Bright Data.
- Auction PDF won't parse: switch to manual entry into the worksheet; log which rows were manual.
- Valuation import fails / values missing: pull values manually from Laser (SOP 8) and enter with source+date; mark MISSING what you can't get.
- Laser login fails: re-check credentials; subscription active? MFA? -> escalate to owner if unresolved.
- Bridge/browser workflow fails: refresh the Laser tab ('session expired'); confirm you're on the Laser app page; re-check the SECRET; restart the script.
- Score looks wrong: verify the values + trim/mileage (SOP 9). Wrong trim = wrong value. If values are right but score seems off, flag to manager.
- Duplicate lead appears: keep the most complete one, note the duplicate; don't double-contact the seller.
- Outreach tool down: send manually from an approved number and LOG it in CarHunter by hand.
- You made a mistake: stop, log exactly what happened, tell your manager immediately. Do not cover it up.
- Internet/comms down: switch to mobile hotspot if approved; keep a timestamped manual log; re-enter into CarHunter once back.

Decision rules

- Always prefer a logged manual fallback over stopping entirely — unless data integrity is at risk.
- If you can't trust the data, STOP and escalate rather than act on bad data.
- Anything down >15 min that blocks the desk -> notify owner.

What to enter into CarHunter

What broke, when, what you did, and re-enter any data captured manually during the outage.

What not to do

- Don't keep bidding/buying on data you can't verify.
- Don't hide mistakes.
- Don't start a permanent side spreadsheet.

Escalation triggers

Anything unresolved in ~15 min, any data-integrity risk, Laser/subscription/token problems, or a mistake that affected a live deal.

Common mistakes

- Assuming the code broke when it's a key/token
- Not logging the manual fallback
- Continuing on bad data

Completion checklist

- Symptom identified
- Fallback used + logged
- Owner/manager notified if needed
- Manual data re-entered
- Root cause noted

Example

Feed stops updating. Bridge shows 'posted' fine, but no new KSL cars in 40 min. You notify the owner ('likely Bright Data token/balance'), and keep working existing leads + follow-ups meanwhile.

SOP 14: Data Quality & Audit SOP

Purpose

Keep CarHunter clean, trustworthy, and auditable so decisions are based on real, sourced data.

Who owns the process

You maintain it daily; manager audits (SOP 16).

When to use it

Continuously, plus a quick end-of-day sweep.

Required tools

- CarHunter
- This SOP

Standards (every record must meet these)

- One row per real car (watch for duplicates).
- Every value shows source + date.
- Missing data is marked MISSING, not blank-and-ignored or guessed.
- Every lead has a status + next action.
- Every seller conversation is logged.
- Every escalation + owner decision is logged.

Step-by-step process

- 1. As you work, enter sources/dates on values and log conversations in real time (not from memory later).
- 2. End-of-day sweep: scan your touched leads for missing sources, un-logged replies, or no next action; fix them.
- 3. Flag duplicates and merge per manager guidance.
- 4. Note the label quirk: Laser values may display source 'carbly' (legacy tag) — still record the real source/date in notes.

Decision rules

- If you can't source a value, it's MISSING.
- If two records are the same car, keep the most complete and note the merge.
- Never edit history to hide a mistake — add a correcting note.

What to enter into CarHunter

Sources, dates, statuses, next actions, conversation logs, and correction notes.

What not to do

- No guessed values.
- No blank sources.
- No silent overwrites.
- No side spreadsheets (unapproved).

Escalation triggers

Systemic data problems (lots of missing values, wrong sources, duplicates) -> tell your manager so the root cause gets fixed.

Common mistakes

- Logging from memory at end of day (errors creep in)
- Leaving sources blank
- Ignoring duplicates

Completion checklist

- No blank sources on touched leads
- All replies logged
- All open leads have next actions
- Duplicates flagged
- EOD sweep done

Example

EOD sweep finds a Camry with KBB but no source noted and a missing JD Retail. You add 'KBB \$13,500 — Laser 6/21', pull JD Retail from Laser, and set the next action.

SOP 15: Employee Training Plan & Certification Checklist

Purpose

Take a new hire from zero to certified desk operator in 5 days.

Day 1 — CarHunter overview, daily workflow, private-party leads, outreach basics

- Read SOP 1 + Capability Map.
- Shadow the daily routine (SOP 2).
- Work 5 practice leads (SOP 3) read-only.
- Learn the Script Book (SOP 4); send 3 supervised messages.
- Practice logging conversations (SOP 14).

Day 2 — Valuation basics, Laser, JD/KBB/MMR, recon, fees, deal score

- Set up + verify the Laser bridge (SOP 8).
- Capture JD Clean/Retail/KBB/MMR on 5 cars (SOP 9).
- Learn how recon, fees, profit, and deal score are built.
- Verify values with sources+dates; practice marking MISSING.

Day 3 — Auction run-lists, mechanic-special flags, engine/transmission pricing

- Work a sample run-list (SOP 5).
- Identify trigger phrases; complete 2 Repair-Margin Worksheets (SOP 6) with the 3 walk-away formulas.
- Call 2 Utah vendors for engine/trans quotes and fill the quote log (SOP 7).

Day 4 — Owner packets, inspection scheduling, follow-up, troubleshooting

- Build 2 Owner Decision Packets (SOP 10).
- Schedule a mock inspection (SOP 11).
- Run the follow-up cadence on 3 leads (SOP 12).
- Walk every troubleshooting symptom (SOP 13).

Day 5 — Supervised live queue, quality review, certification test

- Run the live queue solo with the manager watching.
- Manager runs the QC checklist (SOP 16).
- Pass the certification checklist below.

Certification Checklist — the employee can:

- Work a private-party lead end to end (SOP 3)
- Send approved outreach correctly (SOP 4)
- Log a seller reply completely (SOP 4/14)
- Schedule an appointment (SOP 11)
- Import/verify valuations with sources+dates (SOP 8/9)
- Review an auction run-list (SOP 5)

- Complete an engine/transmission Repair-Margin Worksheet with all 3 walk-aways (SOP 6)
- Prepare a complete Owner Decision Packet (SOP 10)
- Troubleshoot a failed import/feed and use a logged fallback (SOP 13)
- Explain every escalation trigger from memory (SOP 10)

Sign-off: Employee _____ Manager _____ Date _____ (Certified to run the desk.)

SOP 16: Manager Quality-Control Checklist

Purpose / cadence

A fast daily/weekly audit to keep the desk accurate, fast, and compliant. Run daily for new hires, weekly once certified.

Daily spot-check (sample 5-10 leads)

- Every value has a source + date (no blanks, no guesses)
- Missing data marked MISSING, not invented
- Every touched lead has a status + next action
- Every seller conversation logged (not from memory)
- HOT/fresh cars were contacted quickly
- Mechanic specials have a Repair-Margin Worksheet
- No bids/purchases without owner approval
- No unapproved side spreadsheets

Weekly review

- Missed/expired HOT deals reviewed for root cause (slow contact? approval delay? wrong value?)
- Escalations were complete (all packet fields, one clear ask)
- Owner decisions logged + acted on
- Duplicates cleaned
- Laser bridge uptime good (values flowing)
- Troubleshooting incidents logged + resolved
- Outreach stayed polite/compliant (no spam, no false claims)

Scoring

Green = standards met. Yellow = minor gaps, coach. Red = data-integrity or escalation failure -> retrain on the specific SOP and re-audit next day.

SOP 17: Appendix — Templates, Forms, Logs, Decision Tree

A. Daily Desk Checklist

- Confirm Laser bridge running ('posted' in console)
- Confirm feed updating (new cars today)
- Triage HOT + mechanic specials first
- Work each lead (SOP 3) + log
- Work follow-ups (SOP 12)
- Send owner packets (SOP 10)
- Process auction run-list if any (SOP 5/6)
- EOD: every lead has a next action; all conversations logged; MISSING marked

B. Owner Decision Packet — copy/paste template

Vehicle: {year} {make} {model} {trim} | Mileage: ____ | Location: ____

Source/link: ____

Asking / lane estimate: \$ ____

JD Clean Trade: \$ ____ (src/date) | JD Full Retail: \$ ____ (src/date)

KBB Lending: \$ ____ (src/date) | Base MMR: \$ ____ (src/date)

Est recon: \$ ____ | Est fees: \$ ____ | Est profit: \$ ____ | Deal score: ____

Repair scenarios (if any): engine walk-away \$ ____ / trans walk-away \$ ____ / worst-case \$ ____

Risk flags: ____

Seller conversation summary: ____

Inspection status: ____

My recommendation: ____

EXACT decision requested: ____

C. Repair-Margin Worksheet — blank

Field	Value
Vehicle / VIN / mileage	
Auction lane / run	
Announcement	
Title status	
Exit strategy (retail/wholesale)	
JD Clean Trade	
JD Full Retail	
KBB Lending	
Base MMR	
Expected exit value	
Auction fees	
Transport	
Title/admin fees	
Standard recon (\$400)	
Engine part low/mid/high	
Engine labor reserve (\$1,000)	
Transmission part low/mid/high	

Field	Value
Transmission labor reserve (\$1,000)	
Diagnostic reserve (\$250)	
Unknown-risk reserve (\$750)	
Target profit (\$1,500+; specials \$2-3k)	
Walk-away (engine)	
Walk-away (transmission)	
Walk-away (worst case)	
Recommended action / max bid	

D. Utah Parts/Labor Quote Log — blank

Field	Value
Vendor name	
Contact method	
Contact person	
Phone / URL	
Date/time	
VIN or Y/M/M/engine	
Engine/trans code	
Mileage on used part	
Warranty	
Part-only price	
Core charge	
Shipping/delivery	
Availability	
Labor quote	
Notes	
Confidence (H/M/L)	

E. Inspection Checklist

- ☐ Title clean + in hand (matches VIN)
- ☐ VIN on car matches listing
- ☐ Cold start / no knock / no smoke
- ☐ Transmission shifts + reverse works
- ☐ No major leaks / overheating
- ☐ Frame + panel gaps (accident/flood signs)
- ☐ Tires/brakes condition
- ☐ Electronics + AC
- ☐ Test drive done
- ☐ Photos taken + attached to lead
- ☐ Condition vs listing noted

F. Escalation Decision Tree

- Score 90+? -> ESCALATE.
- Profit over owner threshold OR spend over your authority? -> ESCALATE.
- Salvage/rebuilt/branded/flood/frame OR major mechanical? -> ESCALATE (with SOP 6 worksheet).
- VIN missing on a valuable car? -> request VIN; if still missing -> ESCALATE.
- Values conflict materially? -> ESCALATE.
- Seller pushing now / auction lane time close? -> ESCALATE now.
- Unsure for any reason? -> ESCALATE. (When in doubt, escalate.)
- None of the above + within your authority + clean + verified? -> proceed per SOP and set next action.

G. Status vocabulary (use these exactly)

Lead states: New | Contacted | Waiting reply | Negotiating | Inspection scheduled | Owner review | Approved | Bought | Flipped | Watch | Dead | Missed. Every Dead/Missed needs a reason. Every open state needs a next action + date.

H. Key numbers quick-reference (owner Settings override these)

Number	Default
HOT threshold (min profit)	\$1,500
Fees (flat)	\$400
Base recon	\$400
Engine labor reserve	\$1,000
Transmission labor reserve	\$1,000
Diagnostic reserve	\$250
Unknown-risk reserve	\$750
Title/admin	\$150
Mechanic-special target profit	\$2,000-\$3,000
Price-outlier flag	price < ~35% of book

End of binder. Verify the Capability Map and the live Laser screens (SOP 8) before your first solo shift.